Republic of the Philippines
PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY
Camarines Sur

Master in Information Technology (MIT)
Admission and Retention Policy

I. Academic Requirements for Admission

- Bachelor's degree in Information Technology, Computer Science, Information Systems, or closely allied programs (e.g., Computer Engineering, ECE with substantial computing exposure).
- Professionals working in the IT field (e.g., software development, systems/network administration, data analytics, cybersecurity, IT project management) may qualify upon evidence of readiness for graduate study.
- Applicants with non-IT/non-allied bachelor's degrees may be conditionally admitted subject to completion of mid-year Bridging courses prior to enrollment in regular MIT coursework.

II. Admission Requirements (Process and Criteria)

A. Program-Specific Readiness

- Department evaluation of undergraduate preparation and/or professional experience to confirm fit to the MIT curriculum and to identify any bridging needs.
- If gaps are identified, bridging is prescribed (see Section V).

B. University-Standard Process (New Students)

- Screening and evaluation by the Department Chair/Graduate Program Coordinator.
- Registration in the University's enrollment system, assessment and payment of fees, and subject validation with the University Registrar.

C. Academic Load on First Enrollment

- Per University practice, graduate students may carry 3–9 units per semester (minimum 3, maximum 9), subject to prerequisites and any bridging requirements.

III. Documentary and Other Requirements for Admission

- Completed Application Form and updated Curriculum Vitae (CV).
- Two (2) recommendation letters from former instructors/supervisors.
- Concept Note/Brief (1–2 pages) describing intended IT interests/capstone direction.
- Two (2) recent 1×1 ID photos.
- PSA Birth Certificate; PSA Marriage Certificate (if applicable).
- Official Transcript of Records (TOR); Transfer Credential/Honorable Dismissal for transferees (sealed and submitted per Registrar protocol).
- Any college/department endorsements and Registrar forms required during enrollment/validation.

- For non-IT/non-allied applicants: signed agreement to complete the mid-year Bridging Program prior to enrollment in regular MIT courses.

IV. Retention and Progression Policy

A. Good Academic Standing

- Passing grade for master's courses is 2.0 (equivalent to 87). Grades below 2.0 constitute course failure and must be repeated if required by the program.
- Attendance: Accumulated absences of 20% of contact hours result in being dropped with a grade of 5.0. Excused absences require valid documentation.
- Incomplete (INC) grades must be removed within one (1) semester; otherwise they lapse to a failing grade per University policy.

B. Academic Load and Prerequisites

- Regular load is 3–9 units per semester. Prerequisites must be completed before advanced courses; taking advanced courses without prerequisites invalidates the advanced course grade.

C. Comprehensive Examination (CE)

- Required for program completion unless covered by a publication-based exemption set by the program. Passing grade is 2.0 (87).
- A maximum of two (2) attempts is allowed; thereafter, a 3-unit refresher is required before re-taking.

D. Residency

- Maximum Residency Rule (MRR): 5 years for master's. Approved LOA periods do not count against MRR.
- If MRR is exceeded, the student must take 6 units of penalty courses and finish within 2 years. Minimum residency of 1 year prior to graduation applies.

E. Capstone, Publication, and Graduation Milestones (MIT-specific)

- MIT is non-thesis and requires 36 units including 6 units of Graduate Project (Capstone 1 & 2).
- Students must pass the CE or qualify for early publication exemption, then complete Capstone 1–2 with proposal/final defense.
- Publication requirement: Two refereed outputs—one tied to the capstone (journal or Scopus-indexed conference) and a second refereed publication prior to graduation.

F. Leave of Absence (LOA), Readmission, and Reinstatement

- LOA may be granted (e.g., personal, medical, parental) up to 1 academic year (2 semesters); LOA time is excluded from MRR.
- Readmission follows evaluation and Dean approval.

G. Transfer/Advanced Credits

- Up to 50% of program units may be credited if courses are equivalent and have grades ≥ 1.5, subject to evaluation; application must be made during the first semester of residence.

H. Conduct, Integrity, and Disqualification

- Academic honesty and professional conduct follow the University Code of Conduct, Graduate Program Manual of Operations, and Student Handbook. Major violations (e.g., plagiarism) may result in dismissal; lesser violations carry sanctions per University rules.

V. Special Policy for Bridging Program Students (Non-IT/Non-Allied)

- ***Admission Status:*** Conditional admission subject to completion of the mid-year Bridging Program (9 units) prior to the first regular semester.
- ***Enrollment Sequencing:*** Bridging subjects are taken in the mid-year term; upon passing all three, the student proceeds to regular MIT courses following load limits and prerequisites.
- **Assessment and Advising:** Department evaluates undergraduate records and/or work experience to confirm bridging placement; additional support may be recommended.
- ***Load and Progression:*** While on bridging, students typically carry bridging units only; regular 3–9 units/semester applies once admitted in the main program.

VI. Enrollment and Student Flow (Quick Reference)

- **New/First-time Enrollment:** submit credentials → program evaluation → SIAS registration → pay fees → validate subjects → claim EAF/ID.
- **Returnees/Old Students:** secure clearances → subject loading & validation → payment → EAF/ID.
- **Medium of Instruction:** English (Filipino/Bikol as auxiliary as needed); flexible delivery (onsite/online) may be implemented per University policy.

Annex A. Summary Table

Policy Area	MIT-Specific / ParSU Standard
Eligibility	Bachelor's in IT/CS/IS or allied; non-IT allowed with bridging.
Bridging (Non-IT)	Mid-year OOP, Data Structures, Trends in IT (9 units) before first regular term.
Academic Load	3–9 units/term; prerequisites must be satisfied.
Passing Grade	2.0 (87) for master's; INC removal within 1 semester.
Attendance	20% absences → dropped with 5.0.
Comprehensive Exam	Required; 2.0 (87) passing; two attempts then 3-unit refresher.
Capstone	Graduate Project 1 & 2 (6 units total) with proposal/final defense.
Publications	Two refereed publications (capstone-linked + one more) before graduation.
Residency	Max 5 years; LOA not counted; 6 units penalty if exceeded; then finish within 2 years.
Transfer Credit	Up to 50% with grade ≥1.5; apply in first semester.
LOA/Readmission	Up to 1 AY; readmission upon evaluation and Dean approval; MRR clock resumes after LOA.
Conduct	University Code of Conduct; major violations may lead to dismissal.

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